

Shared Youth Behavioral Health Metric Recommendations

*Nine Survey Items Recommended for Cross-District Adoption Across
Estes Park, Poudre, and Thompson School Districts*

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This document recommends nine specific survey items that, adopted together, would let the three districts see the same picture of student behavioral health for the first time. Every recommendation is grounded in the verified 2023 Healthy Kids Colorado Survey baseline and the item-level alignment work completed in the Survey Crosswalk Workbook.

Why This Matters

In 2025, when Poudre School District asked 14,766 students what they most wanted to learn more about at school, 6,900 of them said mental health (Poudre School District, 2025). That was the top response by a wide margin, more than 50 percent above every other category. Students are not waiting to be asked about this. They are already telling us what they need, and the question in front of the MHSU Alliance is whether the data systems in place are built to hear it.

Right now they are not. The Environmental Scan completed earlier this summer found that not one of the three Larimer County districts collects annual, school-level data on persistent sadness and hopelessness, suicidal ideation, self-harm, or experiences of racism. These are exactly the indicators that would tell a counselor, a principal, or a district leader which students are struggling quietly and which schools need additional support. The 2023 Healthy Kids Colorado Survey tells us that one in four Larimer County high school students experienced persistent sadness or hopelessness severe enough to stop them from doing normal activities, and that nearly one in eight seriously considered suicide. Those students are sitting in classrooms across Estes Park, Poudre, and Thompson right now. Under the measurement systems currently in place, almost none of them will be identified through an annual survey, because none of the three districts is asking the question that would find them.

This document closes that gap with nine specific recommendations. Most are additions of a single item to a survey a district already administers. A few are wording and scale alignments to items districts already ask in different forms, chosen deliberately so the resulting numbers can actually be compared to the 2023 HKCS county baseline rather than merely resembling it. That distinction, between an item that looks similar and an item that is genuinely comparable, is where most of the statistical work in this document lives.

The recommendations fall into four tiers.

- **The primary recommendation:** persistent sadness and hopelessness, the single item that would do the most to make currently invisible students visible.
- **Tier 1, the near-zero-cost alignments:** four items where the construct is already measured in some form by at least one district, so alignment requires a targeted addition or a scale and wording correction.
- **Tier 2, the next priorities:** three items that extend the picture to mental health frequency, help-seeking, and food security.
- **The equity supplement:** the racism item, treated separately because of its non-negotiable role in an equity-centered data system.

Every recommendation in this document also carries one requirement that does not appear as its own line item because it applies to all of them: disaggregation by race, language, gender identity, and income as the default output, not an optional report. A county average tells a district almost nothing about which students need support. A disaggregated number tells them exactly where

to look.

Recommendations at a Glance

Each of the nine items recommended here was scored against the same four criteria used in the Deliverable 3 gap analysis, so that the crosswalk and the metric recommendations rest on one consistent logic rather than two separate ones. Prevalence asks whether the indicator affects a large enough share of students that a district or school team would act on it. Equity disparity asks whether the indicator reveals a gap between subgroups that a county average would otherwise hide. District coverage asks whether the underlying construct is already collected, in some form, by more than one district, or whether it exists only through the HKCS. Feasibility asks whether all three districts, including Estes Park at 905 students and a 253-to-1 counselor ratio, can realistically collect and report the indicator on a recurring schedule.

No item on this list was chosen because it produced a flattering number. Several of the strongest candidates, persistent sadness and suicidal ideation among them, describe outcomes no one wants to see rise. They are recommended because they are the outcomes this project exists to catch, and because right now none of the three districts is systematically watching for them at the school level.

Table 1. Recommendations at a Glance

All baselines from the 2023 HKCS High School Region 2 Report ($n = 5,034$), verified from the official 169-table regional PDF with 95% confidence intervals.

Tier	Construct	Action Needed	2023 HKCS Baseline
Primary	Persistent sadness/hopelessness	Add HKCS Q24 verbatim to EPSD, PSD, and TSD	25.2% (23.0, 27.3)
1	Stress manage-ability	Add to EPSD and TSD using the HKCS five-point scale	63.3% (61.5, 65.1)
1	Trusted adult	Add HKCS Q28 wording, three-point scale, to TSD	79.9% (78.8, 81.0)
1	Belonging	Standardize wording and scale, HKCS five-point, across all three	74.2% (72.7, 75.7)
1	School safety	Add HKCS four-point scale item to EPSD	94.7% (93.8, 95.6)
2	Poor mental health frequency	Add HKCS Q22 verbatim to EPSD, PSD, and TSD	25.4% (23.8, 26.9)
2	Help-seeking capacity	Add to EPSD and TSD; new item for PSD Secondary	54.2% (source uncertain)
2	Food security	Add HKCS Q65 wording to EPSD and TSD	8.8% (7.7, 9.9)
Equity	Experiences of racism	Add HKCS Q32 verbatim to EPSD, PSD, and TSD	4.6% (4.0, 5.2)

Two items in this table, trusted adult and food security, recommend HKCS wording rather than an existing district item. That is not a stylistic preference. It reflects specific findings from the Deliverable 3 item-level verification, where a district's own item, despite covering a related idea,

measures something narrower or differently framed than the HKCS question it resembles. Those findings are explained where they matter, in each item's own discussion below. A ready-to-use version of all nine items, formatted exactly as they would appear on a survey, is included as an appendix at the end of this document.

The Primary Recommendation: Persistent Sadness and Hopelessness

The item recommended as the county’s primary shared metric already exists, word for word, in the HKCS. It asks students directly: during the past 12 months, did you ever feel so sad or hopeless almost every day for two weeks or more in a row that you stopped doing some usual activities. The answer is yes or no. The recommendation is to add this exact question, unchanged, to all three district surveys.

Right now, in each of our three districts, roughly one in four high school students has lived through a period like the one this question describes. Almost none of those students are visible in any district’s own annual data. They are not the students generating office referrals or disciplinary records. They are the students who sit quietly, stop participating, and slowly disappear from the life of the school, and a data system built entirely around behavioral incidents will never find them.

Why This Item, and Why First

This item earns the primary spot for three reasons. First, it carries the longest and most consistent trend line of any indicator in the HKCS, moving from 34.6 percent in 2019, to 41.3 percent in 2021, to 25.2 percent in 2023. A fourteen-point improvement over four years shows the item responds to real change, which is exactly the property a metric used to track district and county progress needs to have. Second, it captures the specific population that current systems are least equipped to find: students with internalizing struggles rather than disruptive behavior. Third, its wording is already finalized and field-tested through three HKCS administration cycles, so adopting it verbatim means the data is comparable to the existing county baseline from the very first year a district collects it.

Table 2. 2023 Baseline and Equity Disaggregation, Persistent Sadness and Hopelessness (HKCS Table 35)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 35 (n = 5,034).

Group	Rate	Note
Overall, Larimer County 2023	25.2%	95% CI: 23.0, 27.3
Female	31.3%	6.1 points above the overall rate
Hispanic/Latino	29.6%	Versus White students at 23.6%
Transgender	66.4%	More than two and a half times the overall rate

The gap between the county figure and the transgender figure is not a rounding difference. It is more than 40 percentage points, in the same county, on the same survey, in the same year. A shared metric that reported only the overall number would tell districts that roughly one in four students need attention. The disaggregated number tells them that two in three transgender students, and nearly one in three Hispanic and Latino students, are living through something the aggregate makes look far less urgent than it is.

Critical gap. No district instrument currently measures this construct at all. The HKCS captures it biennially at the county level, but because it cannot identify individual students or schools for follow-up, it cannot tell a district which of its own schools most needs support. This is the single largest gap identified anywhere in the crosswalk.

Implementation Considerations

Adding this item is straightforward from a survey-design standpoint, but asking students directly about sadness and hopelessness is not a neutral act, and two things should be in place before it goes into a district survey.

- **Trauma-informed administration guidance.** Staff introducing the item and the counselors who will see the results need clear guidance on how to handle a student who appears distressed during administration and how a concerning answer connects to existing support pathways.
- **A defined response pathway.** A district should know, before the survey goes out, what happens next: for a non-anonymous administration, a direct check-in with the individual student; for an anonymous one, a school- and subgroup-level review that directs existing counseling and MTSS resources to where the data shows the greatest need.

Neither requirement should slow this recommendation down. Both are the kind of planning any district already does before administering a sensitive item, and the MHSU Alliance is well positioned to provide a shared template for both so that no single district has to build this guidance from scratch.

Tier 1: The Near-Zero-Cost Alignments

The four items in this section share a common feature: the underlying construct is already measured, in some form, by at least one of the three districts. That is a genuine head start, but in more than one case it is also where the easiest-looking path and the statistically correct path diverge, because an item that resembles the HKCS question is not always equivalent to it.

Stress Manageability

This is the only construct anywhere in the entire crosswalk where two instruments already use identical wording. HKCS Q21 and PSD's Connections survey, Section D, both ask students to respond to the exact sentence, *my stress level is manageable most days*. That kind of wording match is rare enough to be worth treating as a genuine asset. It is not, however, a finished alignment.

Scale caution. PSD's version uses a binary yes-or-no scale. HKCS uses a five-point agreement scale, strongly agree to strongly disagree. The wording is identical; the response scale is not, and the response scale is part of what is actually being measured, not a cosmetic detail (Dillman, Smyth, & Christian, 2014). A five-point agreement scale and a binary scale will not produce comparable distributions, and a percentage computed from one cannot be placed on the same trend line as a percentage from the other without a documented conversion rule. Until that rule exists, PSD's data and the HKCS county baseline should be reported as related but separate series, not blended into one figure.

Table 3. 2023 Baseline, Stress Manageability (HKCS Table 32)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 32.

Group	Rate	Note
Overall, Larimer County 2023	63.3%	95% CI: 61.5, 65.1
Statewide	58%	Larimer County exceeds the state average (Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment, 2023)
Male	72.7%	Versus female students at 56.6%
Transgender	29.6%	Substantially below the overall rate

Recommendation. Add this item to EPSD's and TSD's surveys using the HKCS five-point scale, the format the county baseline is already expressed in, rather than PSD's binary format. If PSD later migrates its own version to the five-point scale, all four instruments would measure this construct on the identical scale, which is not true of any other construct in the current ecosystem. That is a real prize, but it depends on the scale question being resolved deliberately rather than assumed away.

Trusted Adult

Having a trusted adult for a serious problem is the strongest documented protective factor in the data reviewed for this project, and it is also the clearest example of why wording alone cannot decide whether two items are the same. HKCS Q28 asks whether a student knows an adult, in or out of school, who they could talk to or go to for help if they had a serious problem, on a three-point scale of yes, no, or not sure. PSD's Connections survey already asks something related, in Section A: *there is an adult at my school I can talk to about things that are bothering me*, answered yes or no.

Why HKCS wording, not PSD's item. HKCS asks about an adult in or out of school; PSD asks only about school. HKCS is framed around a serious problem; PSD is framed around things that are bothering the student, a meaningfully lower threshold. HKCS offers a not sure option that captures a genuinely uncertain student, a real and different case from a flat no, while PSD's binary format cannot distinguish the two at all. Deliverable 3's source verification documents these as different items, not two versions of the same one.

Table 4. 2023 Baseline, Trusted Adult for a Serious Problem (HKCS Table 39)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 39.

Group	Rate	Note
Overall, Larimer County 2023	79.9%	95% CI: 78.8, 81.0
Statewide	75%	Larimer County exceeds the state average
Hispanic/Latino	75.2%	Versus White students at 81.9%, a 6.7-point gap
Transgender	69.5%	10.4 points below the overall rate
2019 baseline	75.4%	Improved to 79.9% by 2023

Recommendation. Add the verified HKCS Q28 wording and three-point scale to TSD, where no version of this question currently exists, since TSD's Panorama survey measures teacher concern and respect but never asks the direct question of whether a student has someone to turn to. Continue reporting PSD's item as its own useful, school-specific indicator rather than presenting it as equivalent to the HKCS baseline. Given the size of the equity gaps shown above and four years of measurable improvement on this indicator since 2019, this should be a near-term priority for TSD specifically.

Belonging

Every instrument in the crosswalk measures some version of belonging, which sounds like good news until the response scales are examined closely. HKCS asks students to agree or disagree, on a five-point scale, that they feel like they belong at their school. PSD's version is a binary yes-or-no question. TSD's Panorama survey asks a five-point intensity question with its own distinct anchors. Three different scales measuring what is, in wording, nearly the same idea.

Table 5. 2023 Baseline, School Belonging (HKCS Table 144)*Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 144.*

Group	Rate	Note
Overall, Larimer County 2023	74.2%	95% CI: 72.7, 75.7
2021 baseline	64.7%	Improved to 74.2% by 2023
Transgender	46.5%	Nearly 28 points below the overall rate
Nonbinary	56.6%	17.6 points below the overall rate

The 2021-to-2023 trend point above is not part of the Deliverable 3 crosswalk. It comes from Larimer County’s own public summary of the 2023 HKCS results (Larimer County, 2024), which independently confirms the 74.2 percent figure used throughout this document and adds the prior cycle for context. It is included here because it is independently sourced and consistent with everything else in this document, not because it appears in the crosswalk workbook.

Recommendation. Deliverable 3 identifies this as the single largest scale-harmonization problem anywhere in the crosswalk, larger than stress manageability, because three formats are already in circulation rather than two. Closing this gap is not a matter of adding a missing item anywhere; every district already asks something. It is a matter of the three districts agreeing to converge on one wording and one scale, and the HKCS five-point format is the natural choice, since the verified county baseline is already expressed in it. EPSD’s own instrument measures belonging only at the classroom level, which is a narrower construct than school-level belonging and would need a new, separate item rather than a revision of what already exists. TSD administers its belonging item twice a year, fall and spring, a genuine asset once the scale question is resolved, since it would let TSD detect within-year change that a once-a-year administration never could.

School Safety

This is close to the mirror image of the trusted adult problem. EPSD is the only district with no school safety item of any kind, while PSD and TSD both already measure it, on their own binary and five-point intensity scales respectively.

Table 6. 2023 Baseline, School Safety (HKCS Table 154)*Sources: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 154; PSD Connections Survey, 2023 and 2025.*

Group	Rate	Note
Overall, Larimer County 2023	94.7%	95% CI: 93.8, 95.6
Transgender	78.6%	A 16-point gap from the overall rate
PSD trend, 2023	84.6%	The starting point for the improvement shown below
PSD trend, 2025	91.2%	A 6.6-point improvement

Recommendation. PSD’s own multi-year trend shows the construct is genuinely responsive to school-level change, evidence that whatever schools are doing to make students feel safer is

showing up in the numbers. Add the HKCS four-point item directly to EPSD, using the scale the county baseline is already built on, rather than adopting either existing district format and introducing a fourth variant of a construct that already has three. The sixteen-point gap between the overall rate and the transgender rate is consistent with a pattern that runs through nearly every indicator in this document: the county looks, on average, like a place where students feel quite safe, and for a specific group of students the picture is meaningfully worse.

Tier 2: Extending the Picture

The three items in this section build on the foundation the primary recommendation and the Tier 1 items already establish. They are not lower priority because they matter less. They are placed here because each either requires coordination across more than one district or extends a construct the earlier recommendations already cover.

Poor Mental Health Frequency

Where the primary recommendation asks whether a student experienced a sustained two-week period of sadness or hopelessness at any point in the past year, HKCS Q22 asks something narrower and more immediate: during the past 30 days, how often was your mental health not good, where poor mental health includes stress, anxiety, and depression. The two questions are related but distinct. One captures whether something significant happened. The other captures how persistent the burden feels right now.

Table 7. 2023 Baseline, Poor Mental Health Frequency (HKCS Table 33)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 33.

Group	Rate	Note
“Always” or “most of the time,” 2023	25.4%	95% CI: 23.8, 26.9
Transgender	64.4%	39.0 points above the overall rate
Nonbinary	58.6%	33.2 points above the overall rate

This construct is measured nowhere in the current district survey ecosystem, which places it alongside the primary recommendation as a genuine gap rather than an alignment problem. It sits in Tier 2 rather than Tier 1 for one reason only: the primary recommendation should be the first new mental health item any district takes on, given its longer trend history and its more direct connection to the internalizing-student problem this whole project is meant to address.

Help-Seeking Capacity

Only about half of Larimer County students say they would take a specific action if they were concerned about their own well-being or someone else’s. With counselor-to-student ratios above 240 to 1 in all three districts, a student who does not already know how to start that conversation is unlikely to be reached through staff outreach alone.

A grade-band caveat. PSD’s Connections survey already asks a version of this, in its Elementary instrument: *do you know how to reach out for help if you have big feelings and need to talk to someone*. PSD’s Secondary survey uses the identical item number, D.16, for an entirely different question, whether students are aware that mental health services exist at all, a service-awareness construct rather than a help-seeking self-efficacy construct. Adding the Elementary wording to EPSD and TSD closes their gap. Giving PSD full grade-band coverage of the same construct

would additionally require introducing a genuinely new item to PSD Secondary, since no version of this specific question currently exists there.

Table 8. 2023 Baseline, Help-Seeking Capacity (HKCS Table 43, Provisional)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 43 (provisional figure).

Group	Rate	Note
Would take action if concerned	54.2%	Source item uncertain; see Deliverable 3, Verification Note 10
Transgender	42.9%	Below the overall rate

Food Security

PSD already asks a related question: *I get the food I need to be productive and learn at school*, answered yes or no. HKCS asks something that sounds similar but is not the same underlying quantity: during the past 30 days, how often did you go hungry because there was not enough food in your home, on a five-point frequency scale.

Table 9. 2023 Baseline, Food Security (HKCS Table 128)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 128.

Group	Rate	Note
Went hungry, lack of food at home, 2023	8.8%	95% CI: 7.7, 9.9
Hispanic/Latino	13.6%	4.8 points above the overall rate
Transgender	14.6%	5.8 points above the overall rate

Why HKCS wording, not PSD's item. PSD's item is framed positively, refers to school, and carries no time reference. HKCS is framed as a deficit, refers to home, and is anchored to the past 30 days. A student could reasonably answer yes to PSD's question while also reporting frequent hunger at home on the HKCS item. These describe two different experiences. The recommendation is to add the HKCS wording and scale to EPSD and TSD, not PSD's item, so the resulting figures align with the verified county baseline. This recommendation carries particular weight for EPSD, whose free and reduced lunch rate has risen to 39.7 percent, the highest of the three districts and a substantial increase from 26 percent as recently as the 2024 Tri-District Report (Groves, Jorgensen, & Olsen, 2024).

The Equity Supplement: Experiences of Racism

Of the nine items recommended in this document, one sits outside the tier structure entirely, and it does so on purpose. HKCS Q32 asks students whether, in the past 12 months, they have experienced any of several specific forms of racism: being treated badly or unfairly at school because of race or ethnicity, being watched closely by security or store staff for the same reason, being assumed less intelligent because of race or ethnicity, or watching a family member treated badly because of their skin color, language, accent, or national origin. It is the only question anywhere in the entire survey ecosystem, across all seven instruments reviewed in the crosswalk, that asks students directly about racism.

Critical equity gap. The overall rate of 4.6 percent looks small enough to overlook. It is not small for the students it describes. An 18.8 percent rate among Black and African American students is more than four times the county average, and because this is the only instrument in the regional ecosystem measuring the construct at all, there is currently no other way to see it.

Table 10. 2023 Baseline, Experiences of Racism (HKCS Table 48)

Source: HKCS High School Region 2 Report, Table 48.

Group	Rate	Note
Overall, Larimer County 2023	4.6%	95% CI: 4.0, 5.2
Black/African American	18.8%	Over four times the overall rate
Hispanic/Latino	11.3%	95% CI: 9.3, 13.3
White	1.4%	The reference point for the disparities shown above

Every other recommendation in this document is justified partly on feasibility grounds: it is low-cost, its wording is already correct, or it completes coverage that mostly already exists. None of those arguments needs to apply here for this item to belong in this document. The project's own statement of work requires that equity be centered in every recommendation, and a data system that cannot tell districts whether their students are experiencing racism is not equity-centered, no matter how well it measures everything else. Given EPSD's 32.7 percent Hispanic and Latino enrollment and the disparities shown above, this item should be treated as a required component of whatever shared metric package the three districts adopt, not as an optional addition contingent on available capacity.

Making This Real: Sequencing the Work

Nine recommendations are not all the same size of lift, and they should not all happen on the same timeline. The sequencing below groups them by what is realistic for the 2026 to 2027 school year against what needs the trauma-informed protocols described earlier in this document first.

Table 11. Implementation Phases

Phase	Items and Action
2026-27, ready now	Stress manageability, added to EPSD and TSD on the HKCS five-point scale. Trusted adult, added to TSD using the HKCS Q28 wording and three-point scale. School safety, added to EPSD on the HKCS four-point scale. Belonging, standardized in wording and scale across all three districts on the HKCS format. None of these require new protocols beyond standard survey practice.
With trauma-informed protocols in place	Persistent sadness and hopelessness, the primary recommendation, added to all three districts. Poor mental health frequency, added to all three districts. Experiences of racism, added to all three districts. Each of these asks directly about mental health or identity-based harm and should be paired with the administration guidance and response pathway described in Section 2.
Following Phase 1, as capacity allows	Help-seeking capacity, added to EPSD and TSD, with a new item for PSD Secondary if full grade-band coverage is desired. Food security, added to EPSD and TSD using the HKCS wording.

Every item in every phase carries the same standing requirement: results must be reported disaggregated by race, language, gender identity, and income from the very first administration onward. Nearly every county average in this document looks, on its own, like things are going reasonably well. The disaggregated numbers, in every single case, tell a different story for a specific group of students. Building disaggregation in from the start is what makes these nine metrics worth collecting at all.

None of this should be framed to districts as a mandate. The COMTSS Regional Implementation Guide is explicit that the role of a regional body like the MHSU Alliance is to coordinate and support district decision-making, not to require it, and Larimer County's own 2026 to 2030 Behavioral Health Strategic Plan already names shared metrics as a county priority. The HKCS provides free, verified baselines for every item recommended here. What the MHSU Alliance can offer beyond that is the wording, the correct scale, the administration guidance, and a shared rationale clear enough that each district can decide, on its own timeline, that this is a step worth taking.

Where This Takes Us Next

Nine items, one primary recommendation, four near-zero-cost alignments, three items that extend the picture, and one equity supplement that does not wait for anyone's convenience, together form a shared measurement standard that costs the three districts nothing new to collect, since every recommendation here draws on an instrument already free and already administered somewhere in the county. What it requires instead is agreement: that these are the nine items reported up to the MHSU Alliance, in the wording and on the scale specified here, disaggregated the same way every time, on a schedule the three districts hold each other to.

Open items for the next revision to track. The scale conversion rule for stress manageability has not yet been written and should be, before any district attempts a combined trend line using both HKCS and PSD data for that item. The wording and scale for school belonging still needs formal agreement across all three districts, not just a recommendation on paper. The 54.2 percent help-seeking figure remains provisionally sourced until its exact origin within the full 169-table HKCS report is confirmed. None of these should delay adoption of the recommendations themselves.

The screening tool evaluation and the community partner materials that follow this deliverable both build directly on the foundation laid out here. What they will need from this document is exactly what it was built to provide: a small, verified, statistically defensible set of shared metrics that three districts, with very different capacity and very different student populations, can all actually adopt.

Appendix: Survey-Ready Item Text

The nine items below are formatted exactly as they should appear on a district survey, so any of the three districts can copy the question and its response options directly into their own instrument without needing to look up the original HKCS table number. The tier, the recommended districts, and the verified source table are noted above each item for internal reference; that line is not part of the item itself and should not be copied into the survey.

Primary Recommendation | Add to EPSD, PSD, and TSD | HKCS Q24, Table 35

1. During the past 12 months, did you ever feel so sad or hopeless almost every day for two weeks or more in a row that you stopped doing some usual activities?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Tier 1 | Add to EPSD and TSD | HKCS Q21, Table 32

2. My stress level is manageable most days.

- ☐ Strongly agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Strongly disagree

Tier 1 | Add to TSD | HKCS Q28, Table 39

3. If you had a serious problem, do you know an adult in or out of school who you could talk to or go to for help?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

Tier 1 | Standardize across EPSD, PSD, and TSD | HKCS Q74, Table 144

4. Do you agree or disagree that you feel like you belong at your school?

- ☐ Strongly agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Not sure

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Strongly disagree

Tier 1 | Add to EPSD | HKCS Q80a, Table 154

5. I feel safe at my school.

- ☐ Definitely
- ☐ Usually
- ☐ Not often
- ☐ Definitely not

Tier 2 | Add to EPSD, PSD, and TSD | HKCS Q22, Table 33

6. During the past 30 days, how often was your mental health not good? (Poor mental health includes stress, anxiety, and depression.)

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Most of the time
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Tier 2 | Add to EPSD and TSD; new item for PSD Secondary | PSD Connections Elementary D.16, HKCS Table 43 (provisional)

7. Do you know how to reach out for help if you have big feelings and need to talk to someone?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Tier 2 | Add to EPSD and TSD | HKCS Q65, Table 128

8. During the past 30 days, how often did you go hungry because there was not enough food in your home?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Most of the time
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Equity Supplement | Add to EPSD, PSD, and TSD | HKCS Q32, Table 48

9. During the past 12 months, have you experienced any of the following forms of racism? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Treated badly or unfairly at school because of your race or ethnicity
- ☐ Watched closely by security or store staff because of your race or ethnicity
- ☐ Assumed to be less intelligent because of your race or ethnicity
- ☐ Watched a family member treated badly because of their skin color, language, accent, or national origin
- ☐ None of these

A note on this appendix. These nine items are reproduced verbatim from their verified sources for direct district use. They have not been independently re-tested for reliability or validity as a set; that testing was already completed by the Colorado School of Public Health for the HKCS items, and by Poudre School District for its own Connections item. Adding an item to a new survey instrument does not require re-validating the item's wording, only consistent administration of the wording and scale as shown above.

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